

Elowen Hartwell

Character Dossier

Stubborn, principled and tired fishmonger of the harbor town of Saltmarsh

Overview

Elowen Hartwell is a fishmonger living in the harbor town of Saltmarsh. Elowen is 60 years old, originally from Marrow's End, and is known around the Old Quay as stubborn, principled and tired. In conversation Elowen uses trade jargon and then patiently explains it.

Background

Elowen arrived in the harbor town of Saltmarsh 18 years ago after leaving Marrow's End under circumstances Elowen describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Harbormasters' Guild; the second was the one that stuck. Today Elowen works as a fishmonger near Gull Street market and is paid, when paid at all, in silver marks.

Elowen learned the trade from Xavier Ellery, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Elowen's life is with Rosalind Falkenrath, over a matter neither will explain. The person Elowen trusts most is Torvald Norwood.

Current goal: to prove Rosalind Falkenrath wrong about the old tunnels. Greatest fear: letting Torvald Norwood down.

Personality and speech

Temperament: stubborn, principled and tired.

Speech pattern: Elowen uses trade jargon and then patiently explains it.

Tells: when lying, Elowen mentions Clementine the gecko for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Elowen Hartwell
<i>Role</i>	fishmonger
<i>Home</i>	the harbor town of Saltmarsh
<i>Hometown</i>	Marrow's End
<i>Age</i>	60
<i>Favourite dish</i>	cold salt-baked potatoes
<i>Pet</i>	Clementine, a gecko

<i>Lucky number</i>	812
<i>Workshop password</i>	cedar-amber
<i>Mentor</i>	Xavier Ellery
<i>Rival</i>	Rosalind Falkenrath
<i>Closest friend</i>	Torvald Norwood

Secret

Elowen cannot actually read the old script everyone assumes they can, and has memorised the important pages.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Elowen: I am the fishmonger. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Elowen: Cold salt-baked potatoes. Do not tell Rosalind I said so.

Visitor: Is Clementine yours?

Elowen: Clementine belongs to nobody. Clementine tolerates me. Lucky number is 812, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, winter of year 39

At the Brine and Bell tavern, Elowen taught Torvald how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone. Elowen closed early, walked to the Tidewatch lighthouse, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance. Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Brine and Bell tavern: 71 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. Elowen found a coil of rope half-buried near the Brine and Bell tavern and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Elowen was hired to carry a coil of rope from the Brine and Bell tavern to the Tidewatch lighthouse without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 2, spring of year 39

Elowen found a signal flag half-buried near the Old Quay and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Old Quay: 13 of everything, except the spool of wire, which is always short. Xavier visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 3, winter of year 39

Elowen repaired the clockwork bird at the drydocks for Winifred, who paid in 85 silver marks and a long story about the quarantine. Elowen won 11 silver marks from Rosalind on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on cold salt-baked potatoes. Elowen was hired to carry a brass lantern from the drydocks to the Tidewatch lighthouse without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Elowen and Rosalind outside the drydocks; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Elowen closed early, walked to the Tidewatch lighthouse, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance.

Entry 4, winter of year 39

Elowen repaired the wax seal at the drydocks for Percival, who paid in 38 silver marks and a long story about the census. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right. Elowen found a wax seal half-buried near the drydocks and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Elowen closed early, walked to Gull Street market, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance.

Entry 5, summer of year 40

Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the Tidewatch lighthouse. Elowen pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Dashiell came by asking about the quarantine. Elowen said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a iron kettle on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right.

Entry 6, autumn of year 40

Zeph came by asking about the tariff on salt. Elowen said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Elowen moved the spool of wire indoors, fed Clementine, and wrote three lines to Xavier about the census. Elowen was hired to carry a sextant from the Tidewatch lighthouse to the drydocks without opening it, and mostly succeeded. The weather turned. Elowen moved the bolt of linen indoors, fed Clementine, and wrote three lines to Xavier about the tax on doors. Elowen found a coil of rope half-buried near the Tidewatch lighthouse and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 7, summer of year 40

Elowen spent the day counting stock at Gull Street market: 45 of everything, except the oilskin map, which is always short. A stranger asked Elowen for the password to the workshop. Elowen laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Elowen moved the pair of spectacles indoors, fed Clementine, and wrote three lines to Xavier about who really won the regatta.

Entry 8, summer of year 40

Someone left a wax seal on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right. Elowen won 37 silver marks from Rosalind on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on cold salt-baked potatoes. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Elowen and Rosalind outside the Old Quay; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Elowen repaired the grain scale at the Old Quay for Delphine, who paid in 60 silver marks and a long story about the new curfew.

Entry 9, summer of year 40

A dispute over the census flared up between Elowen and Rosalind outside the Tidewatch lighthouse; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Elowen for the password to the workshop. Elowen laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Elowen was hired to carry a hand bell from the Tidewatch lighthouse to the Brine and Bell tavern without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Sixten came by asking about the quarantine. Elowen said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 10, summer of year 40

Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Brine and Bell tavern: 38 of everything, except the tin whistle, which is always short. Elowen closed early, walked to the Tidewatch lighthouse, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance. At the Brine and Bell tavern, Elowen taught Torvald how to tell a real signal flag from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 11, spring of year 40

A stranger asked Elowen for the password to the workshop. Elowen laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right. Elowen closed early, walked to the Brine and Bell tavern, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance. At the Old Quay, Elowen taught Torvald how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Elowen found a ledger half-buried near the Old Quay and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 12, summer of year 40

Elowen was hired to carry a brass lantern from Gull Street market to the Brine and Bell tavern without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At Gull Street market, Elowen taught Torvald how to tell a real tin whistle from a fake one by weight alone. The weather turned. Elowen moved the ledger indoors, fed Clementine, and wrote three lines to Xavier about the tariff on salt. Rumours about the old tunnels reached Gull Street market. Elowen pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 13, spring of year 41

Xavier visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the comet flared up between Elowen and Rosalind outside the Tidewatch lighthouse; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the Tidewatch lighthouse, Elowen taught Torvald how to tell a real iron kettle from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the Tidewatch lighthouse. Elowen pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 14, summer of year 41

The weather turned. Elowen moved the signal flag indoors, fed Clementine, and wrote three lines to Xavier about the price of lamp oil. Elowen won 42 silver marks from Rosalind on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on cold salt-baked potatoes. Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Brine and Bell tavern: 52 of everything, except the oilskin map, which is always short.

Entry 15, autumn of year 41

Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Tidewatch lighthouse: 9 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short. Elowen won 83 silver marks from Rosalind on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on cold salt-baked potatoes. Rosalind came by asking about the quarantine. Elowen said nothing useful and made tea instead. Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Tidewatch lighthouse: 28 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Elowen and Rosalind outside the Tidewatch lighthouse; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 16, spring of year 41

Elowen closed early, walked to the drydocks, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance. A stranger asked Elowen for the password to the workshop. Elowen laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Xavier visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 17, autumn of year 41

Elowen won 65 silver marks from Rosalind on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on cold salt-baked potatoes. Someone left a sack of salt on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right. Xavier visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. Elowen found a hand bell half-buried near the Brine and Bell tavern and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Elowen and Rosalind outside the Brine and Bell tavern; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 18, spring of year 41

Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Tidewatch lighthouse: 42 of everything, except the tin whistle, which is always short. Elowen found a hand bell half-buried near the Tidewatch lighthouse and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. The weather turned. Elowen moved the spool of wire indoors, fed Clementine, and wrote three lines to Xavier about the comet. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right.

Entry 19, summer of year 41

Someone left a bolt of linen on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right. Elowen closed early, walked to the Old Quay, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance. Xavier visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the drydocks, Elowen taught Torvald how to tell a real tin whistle from a fake one by weight alone. Elowen was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the drydocks to the Old Quay without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 20, autumn of year 41

Rumours about the census reached the Old Quay. Elowen pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Imogen came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Elowen said nothing useful and made tea instead. Elowen found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the Old Quay and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Old Quay: 29 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short.

Entry 21, autumn of year 42

Rumours about the comet reached the drydocks. Elowen pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Harbormasters' Guild sent a notice about the comet. Elowen read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Dashiell came by asking about the comet. Elowen said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached the drydocks. Elowen pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Mara came by asking about the tax on doors. Elowen said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 22, autumn of year 42

Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right. Elowen found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the drydocks and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Elowen spent the day counting stock at the drydocks: 39 of everything, except the clockwork bird, which is always short.

Entry 23, spring of year 42

A stranger asked Elowen for the password to the workshop. Elowen laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Elowen moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Clementine, and wrote three lines to Xavier about the comet. The weather turned. Elowen moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Clementine, and wrote three lines to Xavier about the missing shipment. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Elowen and Rosalind outside the Tidewatch lighthouse; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 24, autumn of year 42

A stranger asked Elowen for the password to the workshop. Elowen laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. At the drydocks, Elowen taught Torvald how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone. Magnus came by asking about the tax on doors. Elowen said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 25, autumn of year 43

Elowen won 48 silver marks from Rosalind on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on cold salt-baked potatoes. Elowen spent the day counting stock at Gull Street market: 3 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short. the Harbormasters' Guild sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Elowen read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Xavier visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 26, winter of year 43

Dashiell came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Elowen said nothing useful and made tea instead. Elowen repaired the bolt of linen at the Tidewatch lighthouse for Rhoswen, who paid in 77 silver marks and a long story about the tax on doors. Elowen found a glass float half-buried near the Tidewatch lighthouse and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 27, autumn of year 43

The weather turned. Elowen moved the iron kettle indoors, fed Clementine, and wrote three lines to Xavier about the quarantine. Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Old Quay: 77 of everything, except the grain scale, which is always short. Elowen repaired the iron kettle at the Old Quay for Bram, who paid in 13 silver marks and a long story about the old tunnels.

Entry 28, spring of year 43

Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Brine and Bell tavern: 25 of everything, except the signal flag, which is always short. Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Brine and Bell tavern: 64 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. Rumours about the comet reached the Brine and Bell tavern. Elowen pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right.

Entry 29, winter of year 44

A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Elowen and Rosalind outside the Brine and Bell tavern; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Elowen closed early, walked to the drydocks, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance. At the Brine and Bell tavern, Elowen taught Torvald how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. Elowen found a glass float half-buried near the Brine and Bell tavern and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 30, spring of year 44

Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Tidewatch lighthouse: 86 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short. Elowen was hired to carry a brass lantern from the Tidewatch lighthouse to the Old Quay without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right.

Entry 31, summer of year 44

Xavier visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. Elowen was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the drydocks to the Old Quay without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Elowen repaired the brass lantern at the drydocks for Delphine, who paid in 62 silver marks and a long story about the new curfew.

Entry 32, autumn of year 44

A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Elowen and Rosalind outside the Brine and Bell tavern; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Someone left a wax seal on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right. Elowen closed early, walked to the Old Quay, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right. At the Brine and Bell tavern, Elowen taught Torvald how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 33, winter of year 44

the Harbormasters' Guild sent a notice about the old tunnels. Elowen read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right. Elowen closed early, walked to the Tidewatch lighthouse, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance. Elowen was hired to carry a sextant from the Old Quay to the Tidewatch lighthouse without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 34, autumn of year 44

Xavier visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before. Elowen won 12 silver marks from Rosalind on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on cold salt-baked potatoes. A stranger asked Elowen for the password to the workshop. Elowen laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Brine and Bell tavern: 48 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short.

Entry 35, spring of year 44

Elowen won 81 silver marks from Rosalind on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on cold salt-baked potatoes. Elowen won 44 silver marks from Rosalind on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on cold salt-baked potatoes. A stranger asked Elowen for the password to the workshop. Elowen laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 36, autumn of year 44

Someone left a grain scale on the doorstep with no note. Elowen suspects Torvald and is probably right. Elowen spent the day counting stock at Gull Street market: 70 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short. At Gull Street market, Elowen taught Torvald how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone. Elowen found a grain scale half-buried near Gull Street market and

spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. The weather turned. Elowen moved the copper pipe indoors, fed Clementine, and wrote three lines to Xavier about the right way to mend a net.

Entry 37, autumn of year 44

Elowen closed early, walked to the Old Quay, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance. A stranger asked Elowen for the password to the workshop. Elowen laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Elowen moved the iron kettle indoors, fed Clementine, and wrote three lines to Xavier about the old tunnels. Elowen spent the day counting stock at the Brine and Bell tavern: 32 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short.